

Faculty of Applied Sciences

History of the Faculty of Applied Sciences

- In 1992, under the Gam Udawa project, construction work was commenced in the Buttala area of Monaragala District. On 21 June 1993, the Faculty of Applied Sciences was established under the University of Sri Jayewardenepura.
 - On 07 November 1995, the Faculty of Applied Sciences was established at Sabaragamuwa University of Sri Lanka through a Gazette notification. At the beginning, the Faculty offered three degree programmes.
 1. Natural Resources Degree Programme
 2. Food Science Degree Programme
 3. Physical Science Degree Programme
 - From 28 November 2002, following a continuous class boycott that continued for 62 days, and thereafter a continuous examination boycott that began on 24 January 2003 and continued for 128 days, the three-year degree programmes were developed into four-year special degree programmes, with the relevant curricula being revised accordingly.
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The Struggle to Move the Faculty from Buttala to the Main Campus

- For more than a decade, students of the Faculty of Applied Sciences struggled to move the Faculty from Buttala to the main university premises in order to achieve their objectives. However, despite the efforts made, there was no progressive change for the advancement of the Faculty. As a result, the students were compelled to launch a full-scale struggle.
- Since the establishment of the Faculty of Applied Sciences at the Belihuloya Main Campus was continuously being postponed, the students at that time decided that they could no longer tolerate the situation. On 20 October 2007, at approximately 2.25 a.m., the students left the Faculty premises in Buttala and began travelling towards the Main Campus. It was particularly significant that the administration was unaware of the students' movement until they had travelled a considerable distance from the Faculty premises.

- When the students travelling from Buttala reached the road, they were stopped at a police roadblock approximately 25 km from Buttala. The then Vice-Chancellor instructed the students to stop there.
 - Subsequently, the three buses transporting the students from Buttala towards the Belihuloya Main Campus were not permitted to pass another police roadblock located approximately 6 km from Belihuloya, near Haldummulla. Therefore, the students travelled the remaining 6 km on foot, together with their belongings, and reached the Main Campus.
 - At that time, it was reported that heavy police security had been provided at the university. When the students of the Faculty of Applied Sciences reached the Main Campus, they were warmly welcomed by the members of the University Students' Union with strong solidarity.
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Reasons for Moving the Faculty of Applied Sciences from Buttala to the Main Campus

- Generally, when lecturers are unavailable for lectures, it is common in universities to obtain the assistance of experienced visiting lecturers. However, since the Buttala area was located approximately 250 km away from Colombo and was a difficult rural area to reach, obtaining the assistance of such lecturers was difficult. This resulted in many educational opportunities being lost by students of the Faculty of Applied Sciences.
 - Due to the very poor level of infrastructure and the location of the Faculty in a forested area, academic activities were disrupted because of incidents involving wild animals at various times.
 - During this period, the Yala National Park, which had been affected by terrorist activities, was located relatively close to Buttala. This further increased concerns regarding the safety of students and the lecturers who were still working at the Faculty at that time.
 - The political situation that existed in Sri Lanka at that time may also have had some influence on the situation.
 - From that point onwards, the students remained within the university despite facing various forms of repression and continued their struggle to establish the Faculty of Applied Sciences at the Main Campus.
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Student Struggles

1. 27 October 2007

A Satyagraha was conducted for approximately one hour on the Badulla–Colombo Road amid heavy rainfall.

2. 01 November 2007

A protest march was conducted from the Main Campus to the Pambahinna Junction.

3. 08 November 2007

A major protest march was conducted from the Main Campus to Balangoda town.

➤ Since no solution was provided by the administration to the students' legitimate and genuine demands, the Sabaragamuwa students commenced a continuous Satyagraha on 10 November 2007 in front of the University Grants Commission and the Ministry of Higher Education in Colombo.

➤ While this Satyagraha was being successfully continued, the administration once again used the police to remove the students who were engaged in the Satyagraha in front of the Ministry of Higher Education on 08 November 2007. Student leaders were also taken into police custody.

➤ The Sabaragamuwa struggle, which had become a major social movement, reached a successful conclusion on 10 December 2007. Following discussions between student representatives and the government at the Parliament complex, the struggle was recorded as a victory of the Sri Lankan student movement.

Addition of New Departments to the Faculty of Applied Sciences

➤ As a result of this struggle, two new departments were added to the Faculty of Applied Sciences. Following a continuous 28-day Satyagraha that commenced on 12 November 2007, the following degree programmes were introduced.

Under the Department of Sports Science and Physical Education

- Sports Science and Management Degree Programme
- Physical Education Degree Programme

Under the Department of Food and Information Systems

- Food and Information Systems Degree Programme

- The foundation stone for the Faculty of Applied Sciences complex, which had been built as a result of the students' struggle, was laid on 31 March 2010.
 - The Faculty complex was originally planned to consist of five floors and all necessary laboratory facilities. However, the building was limited to three floors and was handed over to the students on 31 March 2012.
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The Struggle to Win the Second Phase of the Faculty

- The facilities and available space in the Faculty of Applied Sciences complex, which was opened on 31 March 2012, have now become limited. As a result, both students and lecturers have had to face considerable difficulties.
- Since two floors were removed from the original proposal for a fully equipped five-storey Faculty complex, discussions regarding the second phase of the Faculty became necessary.
- On 22 July 2014, the proposal relating to the second phase was submitted to the University Grants Commission. In addition to the proposals submitted by the administration, students also presented their own proposals. A meeting involving the Faculty Students' Union, the Dean and lecturers was held on 15 September 2015. The complete proposal for the Faculty complex was once again submitted to the University Grants Commission.

Actions Taken by Students

- Through letters, the students informed the lecturers, the Vice-Chancellor, the Minister of Higher Education and the President about the situation.
- Since the administration did not pay sufficient attention to the issue, a protest was conducted on 25 May 2017 as a reminder.
- Even though the administration continued to follow a silent policy, the students once again informed them through letters. Since the issue was still not accepted or addressed, another protest was conducted on 19 September 2017.
- A further protest was conducted on 11 September 2018 from the Faculty premises.
- All the faculties of the university came together and presented the academic and welfare-related issues faced by the university community to the University Grants

Commission. During the protest held on 12 September 2018, attention was once again drawn to the need for the second phase of the Faculty.

- As a result of the continuous struggles carried out by university students, construction work on the second phase of the Faculty of Applied Sciences commenced with the laying of the foundation stone on 12 October 2018.
- The first section of this second phase was opened on 06 April 2022.
- Although the second phase was constructed in this manner, it has still not been completely completed. The struggle to secure its full completion continues.

The Struggle to Establish the Faculty of Computing

- On 02 November 2022, letters were sent to the Presidential Secretariat and the Prime Minister's Office informing them about the establishment of a new Faculty of Computing. Following this, students launched various activities in support of the proposal.
- As one such activity, a large protest march was conducted on 16 November 2022 from the Faculty of Applied Sciences to the main entrance of the university.
- In addition, a petition-signing campaign by students was conducted in front of the Matta Canteen from 23 November 2022.
- On 09 December 2022, student activists conducted a media discussion to inform the public about the proposed establishment of the Faculty of Sports and Faculty of Computing, as well as other common issues affecting the university.
- On 12 December 2022, the Dean of the Faculty of Applied Sciences was informed through a letter about the commencement of the new Faculty.
- As a result of these activities, on 27 December 2022, the Faculty of Computing was gazetted as the 8th Faculty of Sabaragamuwa University of Sri Lanka.

Faculty Cultural Programmes

- **Yadam Mathin Nawum Bimata**
- **Sankalana**
- **Ashwada**

- **Padura**
- **Rathriya Wee**

These are among the main cultural programmes organized by the students of the Faculty.

Faculty Sports Programmes

- **F.S. Thanuka Anurana Cricket Tournament**
 - **Volley Challenge**
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Other Faculty Programmes

- **Sasithya**

(One of the main programmes organized by the students of the Faculty)

- **Vihanga**
 - **Nimeshure**
 - **Tharanaya**
 - **Kiri Ithireeme Programme**
 - **Thai Pongal Programme**
 - **Mihiliya**
 - **Ruwanaara**
 - **Haal Tharagaya**
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Faculty of Applied Sciences Song

Rough and rugged lands beneath us,
Through the roaring seas we came,
Through the dense and difficult forests,
We travelled along our path.

There is still a distance left
To achieve our victory.

Let us rest here for a while,
With learning and patience.

Carrying our determination,
Let us move forward through every difficulty,
As brothers and sisters of Sabaragamuwa.